



Reprinted
February 20, 2026

ENGROSSED HOUSE BILL No. 1165

DIGEST OF HB 1165 (Updated February 19, 2026 3:45 pm - DI 106)

Citations Affected: IC 34-30; IC 35-31.5; IC 35-38; IC 35-43; IC 35-46.

Synopsis: Various animal related matters. Removes partial liability for damages when a person removes a domestic animal from a motor vehicle. Increases certain penalties for offenses involving animals, and establishes a defense for an uninvolved person attacked by a law enforcement animal. Sets forth new definitions and amends various definitions for offenses relating to animals. Specifies that animal cruelty statutes apply to a rodent that is not a nuisance rodent. Makes certain acts an aggravating circumstance for purposes of sentencing.

Effective: July 1, 2026.

**McNamara, Baird, Bartels,
Andrade**

(SENATE SPONSORS — CARRASCO, DEERY)

January 5, 2026, read first time and referred to Committee on Courts and Criminal Code.

January 22, 2026, amended, reported — Do Pass.

January 27, 2026, read second time, ordered engrossed.

January 28, 2026, engrossed. Read third time, passed. Yeas 85, nays 6.

SENATE ACTION

February 2, 2026, read first time and referred to Committee on Corrections and Criminal Law.

February 12, 2026, amended, reported favorably — Do Pass.

February 19, 2026, read second time, amended, ordered engrossed.

EH 1165—LS 6739/DI 150



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February 20, 2026

Second Regular Session of the 124th General Assembly (2026)

PRINTING CODE. Amendments: Whenever an existing statute (or a section of the Indiana Constitution) is being amended, the text of the existing provision will appear in this style type, additions will appear in **this style type**, and deletions will appear in ~~this style type~~.

Additions: Whenever a new statutory provision is being enacted (or a new constitutional provision adopted), the text of the new provision will appear in **this style type**. Also, the word **NEW** will appear in that style type in the introductory clause of each SECTION that adds a new provision to the Indiana Code or the Indiana Constitution.

Conflict reconciliation: Text in a statute in *this style type* or ~~this style type~~ reconciles conflicts between statutes enacted by the 2025 Regular Session of the General Assembly.

ENGROSSED HOUSE BILL No. 1165

A BILL FOR AN ACT to amend the Indiana Code concerning
criminal law and procedure.

Be it enacted by the General Assembly of the State of Indiana:

1 SECTION 1. IC 34-30-30-3, AS ADDED BY P.L.186-2017,
2 SECTION 4, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE
3 JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 3. (a) Except as provided in subsection (c), a
4 person who forcibly enters a motor vehicle to remove a domestic
5 animal from the motor vehicle
6 (1) is liable to the owner or lessee of the motor vehicle for
7 one-half (1/2) of the cost of repairing the damage to the motor
8 vehicle directly caused by the person's forcible entry, unless the
9 owner or lessee of the motor vehicle waives the person's liability
10 under this subdivision; and
11 (2) is immune from any other criminal or civil liability for other
12 property damage resulting from the person's forcible entry of the
13 motor vehicle
14 if all the conditions set forth in subsection (b) are satisfied.
15 (b) For subsection (a)(1) and (a)(2) (a) to apply to a person who
16 forcibly enters a motor vehicle to remove a domestic animal from the
17 motor vehicle, all the following conditions must be satisfied:

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(1) A domestic animal must be present in the enclosed space of the motor vehicle, and the person must reasonably believe that the domestic animal is in imminent danger of suffering serious bodily harm if the domestic animal remains in the motor vehicle.

(2) The person must determine that:

(A) the motor vehicle is locked; and

(B) forcible entry of the motor vehicle is necessary to remove the domestic animal from the motor vehicle.

(3) The person must call telephone number 911 or otherwise attempt to contact:

(A) a law enforcement officer;

(B) a firefighter;

(C) an animal control officer; or

(D) another emergency responder;

before the person forcibly enters the motor vehicle.

(4) The person must use no more force than is reasonably necessary to enter the motor vehicle and remove the domestic animal from the motor vehicle.

(5) The person must remain with the domestic animal until a law enforcement officer, firefighter, animal control officer, or other emergency responder arrives at the scene.

(c) If any of the following persons, acting in the course and scope of the person's employment, forcibly enters a motor vehicle to remove a domestic animal from the motor vehicle, the person is not liable for the cost of repairing damage to the motor vehicle caused by the person's forcible entry:

(1) A law enforcement officer.

(2) A firefighter.

(3) A government officer or employee whose primary duty is to ensure public safety.

(4) An emergency responder other than those identified in subdivisions (1) through (3).

(5) An animal control officer.

(6) A veterinarian who is licensed or otherwise authorized to practice veterinary medicine in Indiana under IC 25-38.1-3.

(7) A veterinary assistant, as defined in IC 25-38.1-14.7.

For the purposes of this subsection, a law enforcement officer may be considered to be acting in the course and scope of the law enforcement officer's employment even if the law enforcement officer is off duty.

SECTION 2. IC 35-31.5-2-51.3, AS ADDED BY P.L.37-2019, SECTION 3, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 51.3. "Companion animal", for purposes of



IC 35-38-2-2.8 **and IC 35-46-3**, has the meaning set forth in IC 35-38-2-2.8.

SECTION 3. IC 35-31.5-2-103, AS ADDED BY P.L.114-2012, SECTION 67, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 103. "Domestic animal", for purposes of ~~IC 35-46-3-12(d)~~ **IC 35-43-4-2 and IC 35-46-3** has the meaning set forth in ~~IC 35-46-3-12(d)~~: **IC 35-46-3-0.5**.

SECTION 4. IC 35-38-1-7.1, AS AMENDED BY P.L.218-2025, SECTION 16, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 7.1. (a) In determining what sentence to impose for a crime, the court may consider the following aggravating circumstances:

(1) The harm, injury, loss, or damage suffered by the victim of an offense was:

(A) significant; and

(B) greater than the elements necessary to prove the commission of the offense.

(2) The person has a history of criminal or delinquent behavior.

(3) The victim of the offense was less than twelve (12) years of age or at least sixty-five (65) years of age at the time the person committed the offense.

(4) The person:

(A) committed a crime of violence (IC 35-50-1-2); and

(B) knowingly committed the offense in the presence or within hearing of an individual who:

(i) was less than eighteen (18) years of age at the time the person committed the offense; and

(ii) is not the victim of the offense.

(5) The person violated a protective order issued against the person under IC 34-26-5 (or IC 31-1-11.5, IC 34-26-2, or IC 34-4-5.1 before their repeal), a workplace violence restraining order issued against the person under IC 34-26-6, or a no contact order issued against the person.

(6) The person has recently violated the conditions of any probation, parole, pardon, community corrections placement, or pretrial release granted to the person.

(7) The victim of the offense was:

(A) a person with a disability (as defined in IC 27-7-6-12), and the defendant knew or should have known that the victim was a person with a disability; or

(B) mentally or physically infirm.

(8) The person was in a position having care, custody, or control



of the victim of the offense.

(9) The injury to or death of the victim of the offense was the result of shaken baby syndrome (as defined in IC 16-41-40-2) or abusive head trauma.

(10) The person threatened to harm the victim of the offense or a witness if the victim or witness told anyone about the offense.

(11) The person:

(A) committed trafficking with an inmate under IC 35-44.1-3-5; and

(B) is an employee of the penal facility.

(12) The person committed the offense with bias due to the victim's or the group's real or perceived characteristic, trait, belief, practice, association, or other attribute the court chooses to consider, including but not limited to an attribute described in IC 10-13-3-1.

(13) The person is or has been an alien (as defined by 8 U.S.C. 1101(a)) unlawfully present in the United States. A determination by the United States Department of Homeland Security that an alien has come to, entered, or remained in the United States in violation of law is evidence that the alien is or has been unlawfully present in the United States.

(14) The offense involved dealing in a controlled substance under IC 35-48-4 and the person distributed the controlled substance to at least three (3) different individuals in a one hundred eighty (180) day period.

(15) The offense resulted in the:

(A) death; or

(B) permanent loss or impairment of the function of a bodily member or organ; of an animal.

(b) The court may consider the following factors as mitigating circumstances or as favoring suspending the sentence and imposing probation:

(1) The crime neither caused nor threatened serious harm to persons or property, or the person did not contemplate that it would do so.

(2) The crime was the result of circumstances unlikely to recur.

(3) The victim of the crime induced or facilitated the offense.

(4) There are substantial grounds tending to excuse or justify the crime, though failing to establish a defense.

(5) The person acted under strong provocation.

(6) The person has no history of delinquency or criminal activity,



1 or the person has led a law-abiding life for a substantial period
2 before commission of the crime.

3 (7) The person is likely to respond affirmatively to probation or
4 short term imprisonment.

5 (8) The character and attitudes of the person indicate that the
6 person is unlikely to commit another crime.

7 (9) The person has made or will make restitution to the victim of
8 the crime for the injury, damage, or loss sustained.

9 (10) Imprisonment of the person will result in undue hardship to
10 the person or the dependents of the person.

11 (11) The person was convicted of a crime involving the use of
12 force against a person who had repeatedly inflicted physical or
13 sexual abuse upon the convicted person and evidence shows that
14 the convicted person suffered from the effects of battery as a
15 result of the past course of conduct of the individual who is the
16 victim of the crime for which the person was convicted.

17 (12) The person was convicted of a crime relating to a controlled
18 substance and the person's arrest or prosecution was facilitated in
19 part because the person:

20 (A) requested emergency medical assistance; or

21 (B) acted in concert with another person who requested
22 emergency medical assistance;

23 for an individual who reasonably appeared to be in need of
24 medical assistance due to the use of alcohol or a controlled
25 substance.

26 (13) The person has posttraumatic stress disorder, traumatic brain
27 injury, or a postconcussive brain injury.

28 (14) The person is a person described in IC 31-30-1-4(d) who
29 committed the offense while the person was a child but is now at
30 least twenty-one (21) years of age.

31 (15) The offense involved a controlled substance under
32 IC 35-48-4 and the person:

33 (A) sought treatment:

34 (i) in the three hundred sixty-five (365) day period
35 preceding the date of the commission of the offense; or

36 (ii) on or after the date on which the person committed the
37 offense, but before sentencing; and

38 (B) successfully completed treatment:

39 (i) in the three hundred sixty-five (365) day period
40 preceding the date of the commission of the offense; or

41 (ii) on or after the date on which the person committed the
42 offense, but before sentencing.



(c) The criteria listed in subsections (a) and (b) do not limit the matters that the court may consider in determining the sentence.

(d) A court may impose any sentence that is:

(1) authorized by statute; and

(2) permissible under the Constitution of the State of Indiana; regardless of the presence or absence of aggravating circumstances or mitigating circumstances.

(e) If a court suspends a sentence and orders probation for a person described in subsection (b)(13), the court may require the person to receive treatment for the person's injuries.

SECTION 5. IC 35-43-4-2, AS AMENDED BY P.L.175-2022, SECTION 7, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 2. (a) A person who knowingly or intentionally exerts unauthorized control over property of another person, with intent to deprive the other person of any part of its value or use, commits theft, a Class A misdemeanor. However, the offense is:

(1) a Level 6 felony if:

(A) the value of the property is at least seven hundred fifty dollars (\$750) and less than fifty thousand dollars (\$50,000);

(B) the property is a:

(i) motor vehicle (as defined in IC 9-13-2-105(a)); ~~or~~

(ii) component part (as defined in IC 9-13-2-34) of a motor vehicle; or

(iii) domestic animal; or

(C) the person has a prior unrelated conviction for:

(i) theft under this section;

(ii) criminal conversion under section 3 of this chapter;

(iii) robbery under IC 35-42-5-1; or

(iv) burglary under IC 35-43-2-1;

(2) a Level 5 felony if:

(A) the value of the property is at least fifty thousand dollars (\$50,000);

(B) the property that is the subject of the theft is a valuable metal (as defined in IC 25-37.5-1-1) and:

(i) relates to transportation safety;

(ii) relates to public safety; or

(iii) is taken from a hospital or other health care facility, telecommunications provider, public utility (as defined in IC 32-24-1-5.9(a)), or critical infrastructure facility;

and the absence of the property creates a substantial risk of bodily injury to a person; or

(C) the property is a:



- 1 (i) motor vehicle (as defined in IC 9-13-2-105(a)); or
- 2 (ii) component part (as defined in IC 9-13-2-34) of a motor
- 3 vehicle; and
- 4 the person has a prior unrelated conviction for theft of a motor
- 5 vehicle (as defined in IC 9-13-2-105(a)) or theft of a
- 6 component part (as defined in IC 9-13-2-34); and
- 7 (3) a Level 5 felony if the property is a firearm.
- 8 (b) For purposes of this section, "the value of property" means:
- 9 (1) the fair market value of the property at the time and place the
- 10 offense was committed; or
- 11 (2) if the fair market value of the property cannot be satisfactorily
- 12 determined, the cost to replace the property within a reasonable
- 13 time after the offense was committed.

14 A price tag or price marking on property displayed or offered for sale
15 constitutes prima facie evidence of the value of the property.

16 (c) If the offense described in subsection (a) is committed by a
17 public servant who exerted unauthorized control over public funds (as
18 defined by IC 5-22-2-23) from the public servant's employer, the
19 employer may be reimbursed in accordance with IC 2-3.5-4-11,
20 IC 2-3.5-5-9, IC 5-10-5.5-19, IC 5-10.3-8-9, IC 5-10.4-5-14,
21 IC 10-12-2-10, IC 33-38-6-19.5, IC 33-39-7-10.5, IC 36-8-6-14,
22 IC 36-8-7-22, IC 36-8-7.5-19, or IC 36-8-8-17.

23 SECTION 6. IC 35-46-3-0.1, AS AMENDED BY P.L.63-2012,
24 SECTION 70, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE
25 JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 0.1. The following amendments to this chapter
26 apply as follows:

- 27 (1) The amendments made to section 12 of this chapter by
- 28 P.L.7-2007 apply only to:
- 29 (A) offenses; and
- 30 (B) acts that would be a crime if committed by an adult;
- 31 that are committed after June 30, 2007.
- 32 (2) The amendments made to sections 8 and 12 of this chapter by
- 33 P.L.171-2007 apply only to crimes committed after June 30, 2007.
- 34 However, the amendments made to section 12(d) of this chapter
- 35 by P.L.171-2007 (**currently codified at section 12(f) of this**
- 36 **chapter**) apply only to:
- 37 (A) crimes; and
- 38 (B) delinquent acts that would be crimes if committed by an
- 39 adult;
- 40 that are committed after June 30, 2007.

41 SECTION 7. IC 35-46-3-0.5, AS AMENDED BY P.L.52-2023,
42 SECTION 2, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE



JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 0.5. The following definitions apply throughout this chapter:

(1) "Abandon" means to desert an animal or to leave the animal without making provision for adequate long term care of the animal. The term does not include leaving an animal in a place that is temporarily vacated for the protection of human life during a disaster.

(2) "Abuse" means to knowingly or intentionally beat, torment, injure, or otherwise harm an animal. ~~The term includes destruction of an animal by any means other than humane euthanasia if the person who destroys the animal is:~~

~~(A) a humane society;~~

~~(B) an animal control agency; or~~

~~(C) a governmental entity operating an animal shelter or other animal impounding facility.~~

(3) "Adequate bedding" means bedding sufficient to permit a domestic animal to:

(A) remain dry;

(B) remain reasonably clean; and

(C) maintain a normal body temperature.

(4) "Adequate shelter" means a covered enclosure sufficient to:

(A) protect an animal from the elements; and

(B) prevent suffering or injury to an animal;

based on the climate and the animal's species, age, and health.

(5) "Companion animal" has the meaning set forth in IC 35-38-2-2.8.

(6) "Domestic animal" means an animal that is not wild. The term is limited to:

(A) cattle, calves, horses, mules, swine, sheep, goats, dogs, cats, poultry, ostriches, rhea, and emus; or

(B) an animal of the bovine, equine, ovine, caprine, porcine, canine, feline, camelid, cervidae, or bison species.

~~(7) "Humane euthanasia" means the humane destruction of an animal using sodium pentobarbital or a derivative, administered in a manner that causes painless loss of consciousness and death.~~

~~The term does not include a method:~~

~~(A) prohibited by section 15 of this chapter; or~~

~~(B) involving the use of carbon monoxide, carbon dioxide, or any nonanesthetic inhalant.~~

~~(8) "Impound agency" means a state, county, municipal, or township agency with the authority to impound animals for~~



violation of this chapter or IC 15-20-1-4. The term includes the following:

(A) A law enforcement agency.

(B) An animal control agency.

~~(5)~~ **(9)** "Mutilate" means to wound, injure, maim, or disfigure an animal by damaging the animal's body parts or to render any part of the animal's body useless. The term includes bodily injury involving:

(A) serious permanent disfigurement;

(B) serious temporary disfigurement;

(C) permanent or protracted loss or impairment of the function of a bodily part or organ; or

(D) a fracture.

~~(6)~~ **(10)** "Neglect" means:

(A) endangering an animal's health by failing to provide or arrange to provide the animal with food or drink, if the animal is dependent upon the person for the provision of food or drink. **Food and drink must be provided in a sufficient quantity to maintain the animal's health and normal development, and in a form that is unspoiled, uncontaminated, and otherwise fit for consumption. Water that is frozen is not sufficient to maintain an animal's health and normal development;**

(B) restraining an animal for more than a brief period in a manner that endangers the animal's life or health by the use of a rope, chain, or tether that:

(i) is less than three (3) times the length of the animal;

(ii) is too heavy to permit the animal to move freely; or

(iii) causes the animal to choke;

(C) restraining an animal in a manner that seriously endangers the animal's life or health;

(D) failing to:

(i) provide reasonable care for; or

(ii) seek veterinary care for;

an injury or illness to a dog or cat that seriously endangers the life or health of the dog or cat; or

~~(E) leaving a dog or cat outside and exposed to:~~

~~(i) excessive heat without providing the animal with a means of shade from the heat; or~~

~~(ii) excessive cold if the animal is not provided with straw or another means of protection from the cold;~~

regardless of whether the animal is restrained or kept in a



- 1 ~~kenel~~ **failing to provide an animal with adequate bedding**
 2 **and adequate shelter.**
 3 ~~(7)~~ **(11)** "Reasonable expenses" includes the cost of:
 4 (A) medical care;
 5 (B) quarantine; and
 6 (C) shelter and board.
 7 ~~(8)~~ **(12)** "Torture" means:
 8 (A) to inflict extreme physical pain or injury on an animal with
 9 the intent of increasing or prolonging the animal's pain;
 10 (B) to administer poison to a domestic animal ~~(as defined in~~
 11 ~~section 12(d) of this chapter)~~ or expose a domestic animal to
 12 a poisonous substance with the intent that the domestic animal
 13 ingest the substance;
 14 (C) to destroy an animal by electrocution in a manner
 15 inconsistent with section 5 of this chapter; ~~or~~
 16 (D) to intentionally ~~freeze or heat an animal to death.~~ **expose**
 17 **an animal to heat or cold beyond an animal's tolerance**
 18 **based on the animal's:**
 19 (i) age;
 20 (ii) health;
 21 (iii) medical conditions; or
 22 (iv) physical characteristics;
 23 **which results in pain, suffering, or death; or**
 24 **(E) to knowingly, intentionally, or recklessly starve,**
 25 **dehydrate, or suffocate an animal.**
 26 SECTION 8. IC 35-46-3-5, AS AMENDED BY P.L.41-2021,
 27 SECTION 9, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE
 28 JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 5. (a) Except as provided in subsections (b)
 29 through (c), this chapter does not apply to the following:
 30 (1) Fishing, hunting, trapping, or other conduct authorized under
 31 IC 14-22.
 32 (2) Conduct authorized under IC 15-20-2.
 33 (3) Generally accepted veterinary standards and practices.
 34 (4) Conduct authorized by a local ordinance.
 35 (5) Acceptable farm management practices.
 36 (6) Conduct authorized by IC 15-17, and rules adopted under
 37 IC 15-17 for:
 38 (A) state or federally inspected livestock slaughtering
 39 facilities;
 40 (B) emergency events; or
 41 (C) state or federal animal disease control programs.
 42 (7) A research facility registered with the United States



Department of Agriculture under the federal Animal Welfare Act
(7 U.S.C. 2131 et seq.).

(8) Destruction of a vertebrate **animal** defined as a pest under
IC 15-16-5-24, **except for a rodent that is not a nuisance
rodent.**

(9) Destruction of or injury to a fish.

(10) Destruction of a vertebrate animal that is:

(A) endangering, harassing, or threatening livestock or a
domestic animal; or

(B) destroying or damaging a person's property.

(11) Humane euthanasia of an animal by:

(A) a humane society;

(B) an animal control agency; or

(C) a governmental entity operating an animal shelter or other
animal impounding facility.

(12) Destruction of an injured or ill animal by an individual to
prevent the animal from prolonged suffering.

(13) Conduct not resulting in serious injury or illness to the
animal that is incidental to exhibiting an animal for show,
competition, or display, or that is incidental to transporting the
animal for show, competition, or display.

(14) Parking an animal.

(15) Humane destruction of an animal that the person owns.

(b) Section 1 of this chapter applies to conduct described in
subsection (a).

(c) Destruction of an animal by electrocution is authorized under
this section only if it is conducted by a person who:

(1) uses generally accepted veterinary standards and practices for
euthanasia, depopulation, or slaughter of animals;

(2) is engaged in an acceptable farm management practice; or

(3) is engaged in activities by a research facility registered with
the United States Department of Agriculture under the Animal
Welfare Act, or for the animal disease diagnostic laboratory
established under IC 21-46-3-1 or a research facility licensed by
the United States Department of Agriculture, a college, or a
university.

SECTION 9. IC 35-46-3-7, AS AMENDED BY P.L.158-2013,
SECTION 558, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS
[EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 7. (a) A person who:

(1) has a vertebrate animal in the person's custody; and

(2) recklessly, knowingly, or intentionally abandons or neglects
the animal;



commits cruelty to an animal, a Class A misdemeanor.

(b) However, except for a conviction under section 1 of this chapter, the an offense under subsection (a) is a Level 6 felony if the:

(1) the person has a prior unrelated conviction under this chapter;

(2) person commits the offense in the presence of a minor; or

(3) abandonment or neglect results in:

(A) serious permanent disfigurement;

(B) unconsciousness;

(C) permanent or protracted loss or impairment of the function of a bodily member or organ; or

(D) death;

of the animal; or

(4) person has ten (10) or more vertebrate animals in the person's custody which results in the person:

(A) failing to provide adequate food, potable water, and adequate shelter to at least one (1) vertebrate animal;

(B) keeping at least one (1) vertebrate animal in an overcrowded environment; or

(C) disregarding the conditions under which at least one (1) vertebrate animal is living in and the harmful impact the conditions have on the health and well-being of the vertebrate animals.

(b) It is a defense to a prosecution for abandoning a vertebrate animal under this section that the person who had the animal in the person's custody reasonably believed that the vertebrate animal was capable of surviving on its own.

(c) For purposes of this section, an animal that is feral is not in a person's custody.

SECTION 10. IC 35-46-3-11, AS AMENDED BY P.L.168-2014, SECTION 86, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 11. (a) A person who knowingly or intentionally:

(1) strikes, torments, injures, or otherwise mistreats a law enforcement animal; or

(2) interferes with the actions of a law enforcement animal while the animal is engaged in assisting a law enforcement officer in the performance of the officer's duties;

commits a Class A misdemeanor.

(b) An offense under subsection (a)(1) is a Level 6 felony if the act results in:

(1) serious permanent disfigurement;

(2) unconsciousness; or

(3) permanent or protracted loss or impairment of the function of



1 a bodily member or organ; ~~or~~
 2 ~~(4) death;~~
 3 of the law enforcement animal.

4 **(c) An offense under subsection (a)(1) is a level 5 felony if the act**
 5 **results in the death of the law enforcement animal.**

6 ~~(c)~~ **(d) It is a defense to a prosecution under this section:**

7 **(1) that the accused person:**

8 ~~(1)~~ **(A)** engaged in a reasonable act of training, handling, or
 9 discipline; and

10 ~~(2)~~ **(B)** acted as an employee or agent of a law enforcement
 11 agency; **or**

12 **(2) that:**

13 **(A) the actions of the accused person were objectively**
 14 **reasonable and taken in good faith to protect the person or**
 15 **another individual from imminent injury by the law**
 16 **enforcement animal; and**

17 **(B) neither the accused person nor the other individual**
 18 **substantially contributed to the circumstances leading to**
 19 **the deployment of the law enforcement animal.**

20 ~~(d)~~ **(e) In addition to any sentence or fine imposed for a conviction**
 21 **of an offense under this section, the court:**

22 **(1) may order the person convicted to make restitution to the**
 23 **person or law enforcement agency owning the animal for**
 24 **reimbursement of veterinary bills; and**

25 **(2) shall order the person convicted to make restitution to the**
 26 **person or law enforcement agency owning the animal for**
 27 **reimbursement of the cost of replacing the animal, which may**
 28 **include the cost of training the animal, if the animal is**
 29 **permanently disabled or killed.**

30 **SECTION 11. IC 35-46-3-12, AS AMENDED BY P.L.141-2019,**
 31 **SECTION 10, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE**
 32 **JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 12. (a) This section does not apply to a person**
 33 **who euthanizes an injured, a sick, a homeless, or an unwanted domestic**
 34 **animal if:**

35 **(1) the person is employed by a humane society, an animal control**
 36 **agency, or a governmental entity operating an animal shelter or**
 37 **other animal impounding facility; and**

38 **(2) the person euthanizes the domestic animal in accordance with**
 39 **guidelines adopted by the humane society, animal control agency,**
 40 **or governmental entity operating the animal shelter or other**
 41 **animal impounding facility.**

42 **(b) A person who knowingly or intentionally abuses a vertebrate**



animal commits cruelty to an animal, a Class A misdemeanor. However, the offense is a Level 6 felony if:

(1) the person has a previous, unrelated conviction under this section; ~~or~~

(2) the person committed the offense with the intent to threaten, intimidate, coerce, harass, or terrorize a family or household member;

(3) the offense is committed in the immediate presence of a minor; or

(4) the act results in:

(A) serious permanent disfigurement;

(B) unconsciousness;

(C) permanent or protracted loss or impairment of the function of a bodily member or organ; or

(D) the death;

of the animal.

(c) A person who knowingly or intentionally tortures or mutilates a vertebrate animal commits torturing or mutilating a vertebrate animal, a Level 6 felony.

(d) As used in this subsection, "domestic animal" means an animal that is not wild. The term is limited to:

(1) cattle, calves, horses, mules, swine, sheep, goats, dogs, cats, poultry, ostriches, rhea, and emus; and

(2) an animal of the bovine, equine, ovine, caprine, porcine, canine, feline, camelid, cervidae, or bison species.

(d) A person who knowingly or intentionally kills a domestic animal without the consent of the owner of the domestic animal commits killing a domestic animal, a Level 6 felony.

(e) It is a defense to a prosecution under this section that the accused person:

(1) reasonably believes the conduct was necessary to:

(A) prevent injury to the accused person or another person;

(B) protect the property of the accused person from destruction or substantial damage; or

(C) prevent a seriously injured vertebrate animal from prolonged suffering; or

(2) engaged in a reasonable and recognized act of training, handling, or disciplining the vertebrate animal.

(f) When a court imposes a sentence or enters a dispositional decree under this section, the court:

(1) shall consider requiring:

(A) a person convicted of an offense under this section; or



1 (B) a child adjudicated a delinquent child for committing an
2 act that would be a crime under this section if committed by an
3 adult;
4 to receive psychological, behavioral, or other counseling as a part
5 of the sentence or dispositional decree; and
6 (2) may order an individual described in subdivision (1) to receive
7 psychological, behavioral, or other counseling as a part of the
8 sentence or dispositional decree.
9 SECTION 12. IC 35-46-3-12.5, AS AMENDED BY P.L.158-2013,
10 SECTION 567, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS
11 [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 12.5. A person who knowingly or
12 intentionally:
13 (1) abuses;
14 (2) abandons;
15 (3) kills; or
16 (4) neglects;
17 a vertebrate animal with the intent to threaten, intimidate, coerce,
18 harass, or terrorize a family or household member commits domestic
19 violence animal cruelty, a Level 6 felony.



COMMITTEE REPORT

Mr. Speaker: Your Committee on Courts and Criminal Code, to which was referred House Bill 1165, has had the same under consideration and begs leave to report the same back to the House with the recommendation that said bill be amended as follows:

Page 1, delete lines 1 through 12.

Page 3, between lines 19 and 20, begin a new paragraph and insert:

"SECTION 5. IC 35-38-1-7.1, AS AMENDED BY P.L.218-2025, SECTION 16, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 7.1. (a) In determining what sentence to impose for a crime, the court may consider the following aggravating circumstances:

(1) The harm, injury, loss, or damage suffered by the victim of an offense was:

(A) significant; and

(B) greater than the elements necessary to prove the commission of the offense.

(2) The person has a history of criminal or delinquent behavior.

(3) The victim of the offense was less than twelve (12) years of age or at least sixty-five (65) years of age at the time the person committed the offense.

(4) The person:

(A) committed a crime of violence (IC 35-50-1-2); and

(B) knowingly committed the offense in the presence or within hearing of an individual who:

(i) was less than eighteen (18) years of age at the time the person committed the offense; and

(ii) is not the victim of the offense.

(5) The person violated a protective order issued against the person under IC 34-26-5 (or IC 31-1-11.5, IC 34-26-2, or IC 34-4-5.1 before their repeal), a workplace violence restraining order issued against the person under IC 34-26-6, or a no contact order issued against the person.

(6) The person has recently violated the conditions of any probation, parole, pardon, community corrections placement, or pretrial release granted to the person.

(7) The victim of the offense was:

(A) a person with a disability (as defined in IC 27-7-6-12), and the defendant knew or should have known that the victim was a person with a disability; or

(B) mentally or physically infirm.



(8) The person was in a position having care, custody, or control of the victim of the offense.

(9) The injury to or death of the victim of the offense was the result of shaken baby syndrome (as defined in IC 16-41-40-2) or abusive head trauma.

(10) The person threatened to harm the victim of the offense or a witness if the victim or witness told anyone about the offense.

(11) The person:

(A) committed trafficking with an inmate under IC 35-44.1-3-5; and

(B) is an employee of the penal facility.

(12) The person committed the offense with bias due to the victim's or the group's real or perceived characteristic, trait, belief, practice, association, or other attribute the court chooses to consider, including but not limited to an attribute described in IC 10-13-3-1.

(13) The person is or has been an alien (as defined by 8 U.S.C. 1101(a)) unlawfully present in the United States. A determination by the United States Department of Homeland Security that an alien has come to, entered, or remained in the United States in violation of law is evidence that the alien is or has been unlawfully present in the United States.

(14) The offense involved dealing in a controlled substance under IC 35-48-4 and the person distributed the controlled substance to at least three (3) different individuals in a one hundred eighty (180) day period.

(15) The offense resulted in the:

(A) death; or

(B) permanent loss or impairment of the function of a bodily member or organ;

of an animal.

(b) The court may consider the following factors as mitigating circumstances or as favoring suspending the sentence and imposing probation:

(1) The crime neither caused nor threatened serious harm to persons or property, or the person did not contemplate that it would do so.

(2) The crime was the result of circumstances unlikely to recur.

(3) The victim of the crime induced or facilitated the offense.

(4) There are substantial grounds tending to excuse or justify the crime, though failing to establish a defense.

(5) The person acted under strong provocation.



- (6) The person has no history of delinquency or criminal activity, or the person has led a law-abiding life for a substantial period before commission of the crime.
- (7) The person is likely to respond affirmatively to probation or short term imprisonment.
- (8) The character and attitudes of the person indicate that the person is unlikely to commit another crime.
- (9) The person has made or will make restitution to the victim of the crime for the injury, damage, or loss sustained.
- (10) Imprisonment of the person will result in undue hardship to the person or the dependents of the person.
- (11) The person was convicted of a crime involving the use of force against a person who had repeatedly inflicted physical or sexual abuse upon the convicted person and evidence shows that the convicted person suffered from the effects of battery as a result of the past course of conduct of the individual who is the victim of the crime for which the person was convicted.
- (12) The person was convicted of a crime relating to a controlled substance and the person's arrest or prosecution was facilitated in part because the person:
 - (A) requested emergency medical assistance; or
 - (B) acted in concert with another person who requested emergency medical assistance;
 for an individual who reasonably appeared to be in need of medical assistance due to the use of alcohol or a controlled substance.
- (13) The person has posttraumatic stress disorder, traumatic brain injury, or a postconcussive brain injury.
- (14) The person is a person described in IC 31-30-1-4(d) who committed the offense while the person was a child but is now at least twenty-one (21) years of age.
- (15) The offense involved a controlled substance under IC 35-48-4 and the person:
 - (A) sought treatment:
 - (i) in the three hundred sixty-five (365) day period preceding the date of the commission of the offense; or
 - (ii) on or after the date on which the person committed the offense, but before sentencing; and
 - (B) successfully completed treatment:
 - (i) in the three hundred sixty-five (365) day period preceding the date of the commission of the offense; or
 - (ii) on or after the date on which the person committed the



offense, but before sentencing.

(c) The criteria listed in subsections (a) and (b) do not limit the matters that the court may consider in determining the sentence.

(d) A court may impose any sentence that is:

(1) authorized by statute; and

(2) permissible under the Constitution of the State of Indiana; regardless of the presence or absence of aggravating circumstances or mitigating circumstances.

(e) If a court suspends a sentence and orders probation for a person described in subsection (b)(13), the court may require the person to receive treatment for the person's injuries."

Page 4, line 8, reset in roman "or".

Page 4, line 15, reset in roman "and".

Page 4, line 15, delete "or".

Page 4, delete lines 16 through 18.

Page 5, line 33, after "emus;" delete "and" and insert "**or**".

Page 7, between lines 25 and 26, begin a new paragraph and insert: "SECTION 8. IC 35-46-3-5, AS AMENDED BY P.L.41-2021, SECTION 9, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 5. (a) Except as provided in subsections (b) through (c), this chapter does not apply to the following:

(1) Fishing, hunting, trapping, or other conduct authorized under IC 14-22.

(2) Conduct authorized under IC 15-20-2.

(3) Generally accepted veterinary standards and practices.

(4) Conduct authorized by a local ordinance.

(5) Acceptable farm management practices.

(6) Conduct authorized by IC 15-17, and rules adopted under IC 15-17 for:

(A) state or federally inspected livestock slaughtering facilities;

(B) emergency events; or

(C) state or federal animal disease control programs.

(7) A research facility registered with the United States Department of Agriculture under the federal Animal Welfare Act (7 U.S.C. 2131 et seq.).

(8) Destruction of a vertebrate **animal** defined as a pest under IC 15-16-5-24, **except for a rodent that is not a nuisance rodent.**

(9) Destruction of or injury to a fish.

(10) Destruction of a vertebrate animal that is:

(A) endangering, harassing, or threatening livestock or a



- domestic animal; or
 - (B) destroying or damaging a person's property.
 - (11) Humane euthanasia of an animal by:
 - (A) a humane society;
 - (B) an animal control agency; or
 - (C) a governmental entity operating an animal shelter or other animal impounding facility.
 - (12) Destruction of an injured or ill animal by an individual to prevent the animal from prolonged suffering.
 - (13) Conduct not resulting in serious injury or illness to the animal that is incidental to exhibiting an animal for show, competition, or display, or that is incidental to transporting the animal for show, competition, or display.
 - (14) Parking an animal.
 - (15) Humane destruction of an animal that the person owns.
 - (b) Section 1 of this chapter applies to conduct described in subsection (a).
 - (c) Destruction of an animal by electrocution is authorized under this section only if it is conducted by a person who:
 - (1) uses generally accepted veterinary standards and practices for euthanasia, depopulation, or slaughter of animals;
 - (2) is engaged in an acceptable farm management practice; or
 - (3) is engaged in activities by a research facility registered with the United States Department of Agriculture under the Animal Welfare Act, or for the animal disease diagnostic laboratory established under IC 21-46-3-1 or a research facility licensed by the United States Department of Agriculture, a college, or a university."
- Page 9, line 40, delete "However, the offense is a Level 5 felony if the act".
- Page 9, delete lines 41 through 42.
- Page 10, delete lines 1 through 3.
- Page 10, line 37, after "knowingly" delete ",".
- Page 10, line 37, reset in roman "or".
- Page 10, delete line 38 and insert "intentionally:".
- Page 11, after line 3, begin a new paragraph and insert:
- "SECTION 12. IC 35-46-3-15, AS AMENDED BY P.L.141-2019, SECTION 11, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 15. (a) This section does not apply to the following:
- (1) A state or federally inspected livestock slaughtering facility (for conduct authorized by IC 15-17-5 and rules adopted under



that chapter).

(2) An animal disease diagnostic laboratory established under IC 21-46-3-1.

(3) A postsecondary educational institution.

(4) A research facility licensed by the United States Department of Agriculture.

(b) As used in this section, "animal" has the meaning set forth in ~~IC 35-46-3-3~~ **section 3 of this chapter.**

(c) A person, **including a humane society, an animal control agency, or a governmental entity operating an animal shelter or other animal impounding facility**, who knowingly or intentionally destroys or authorizes the destruction of an animal by:

(1) placing the animal in a decompression chamber and lowering the pressure of or the oxygen content in the air surrounding the animal; **or**

(2) any means other than humane euthanasia;
commits a Class B misdemeanor."

Renumber all SECTIONS consecutively.

and when so amended that said bill do pass.

(Reference is to HB 1165 as introduced.)

MCNAMARA

Committee Vote: yeas 13, nays 0.

COMMITTEE REPORT

Mr. President: The Senate Committee on Corrections and Criminal Law, to which was referred House Bill No. 1165, has had the same under consideration and begs leave to report the same back to the Senate with the recommendation that said bill be AMENDED as follows:

Page 7, delete lines 41 through 42, begin a new paragraph and insert:

"SECTION 7. IC 35-46-3-0.5, AS AMENDED BY P.L.52-2023, SECTION 2, IS AMENDED TO READ AS FOLLOWS [EFFECTIVE JULY 1, 2026]: Sec. 0.5. The following definitions apply throughout this chapter:

(1) "Abandon" means to desert an animal or to leave the animal

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without making provision for adequate long term care of the animal. The term does not include leaving an animal in a place that is temporarily vacated for the protection of human life during a disaster.

(2) "Abuse" means to ~~knowingly or intentionally~~ beat, torment, injure, or otherwise harm an animal. ~~The term includes destruction of an animal by any means other than humane euthanasia if the person who destroys the animal is:~~

- ~~(A) a humane society;~~
- ~~(B) an animal control agency; or~~
- ~~(C) a governmental entity operating an animal shelter or other animal impounding facility.~~

(3) "Adequate bedding" means bedding sufficient to permit a domestic animal to:

- (A) remain dry;
- (B) remain reasonably clean; and
- (C) maintain a normal body temperature.

(4) "Adequate shelter" means a covered enclosure sufficient to:

- (A) protect an animal from the elements; and
- (B) prevent suffering or injury to an animal;

based on the climate and the animal's species, age, and health.

(5) "Companion animal" has the meaning set forth in IC 35-38-2-2.8.

(6) "Domestic animal" means an animal that is not wild. The term is limited to:

- (A) cattle, calves, horses, mules, swine, sheep, goats, dogs, cats, poultry, ostriches, rhea, and emus; or
- (B) an animal of the bovine, equine, ovine, caprine, porcine, canine, feline, camelid, cervidae, or bison species.

~~(3)~~ (7) "Humane euthanasia" means the humane destruction of an animal using sodium pentobarbital or a derivative, administered in a manner that causes painless loss of consciousness and death.

The term does not include a method:

- (A) prohibited by section 15 of this chapter; or
- (B) involving the use of carbon monoxide, carbon dioxide, or any nonanesthetic inhalant.

~~(4)~~ (8) "Impound agency" means a state, county, municipal, or township agency with the authority to impound animals for violation of this chapter or IC 15-20-1-4. The term includes the following:

- (A) A law enforcement agency.



(B) An animal control agency.

~~(5)~~ (9) "Mutilate" means to wound, injure, maim, or disfigure an animal by damaging the animal's body parts or to render any part of the animal's body useless. The term includes bodily injury involving:

- (A) serious permanent disfigurement;
- (B) serious temporary disfigurement;
- (C) permanent or protracted loss or impairment of the function of a bodily part or organ; or
- (D) a fracture.

~~(6)~~ (10) "Neglect" means:

(A) endangering an animal's health by failing to provide or arrange to provide the animal with food or drink, if the animal is dependent upon the person for the provision of food or drink. **Food and drink must be provided in a sufficient quantity to maintain the animal's health and normal development, and in a form that is unspoiled, uncontaminated, and otherwise fit for consumption. Water that is frozen is not sufficient to maintain an animal's health and normal development;**

(B) restraining an animal for more than a brief period in a manner that endangers the animal's life or health by the use of a rope, chain, or tether that:

- (i) is less than three (3) times the length of the animal;
- (ii) is too heavy to permit the animal to move freely; or
- (iii) causes the animal to choke;

(C) restraining an animal in a manner that seriously endangers the animal's life or health;

(D) failing to:

- (i) provide reasonable care for; or
- (ii) seek veterinary care for;

an injury or illness to a dog or cat that seriously endangers the life or health of the dog or cat; or

(E) leaving a dog or cat outside and exposed to:

- (i) excessive heat without providing the animal with a means of shade from the heat; or
- (ii) excessive cold if the animal is not provided with straw or another means of protection from the cold;

regardless of whether the animal is restrained or kept in a kennel. **failing to provide an animal with adequate bedding and adequate shelter.**

~~(7)~~ (11) "Reasonable expenses" includes the cost of:



- (A) medical care;
- (B) quarantine; and
- (C) shelter and board.

~~(8)~~ **(12)** "Torture" means:

- (A) to inflict extreme physical pain or injury on an animal with the intent of increasing or prolonging the animal's pain;
- (B) to administer poison to a domestic animal ~~(as defined in section 12(d) of this chapter)~~ or expose a domestic animal to a poisonous substance with the intent that the domestic animal ingest the substance;
- (C) to destroy an animal by electrocution in a manner inconsistent with section 5 of this chapter; ~~or~~
- (D) to intentionally ~~freeze or heat an animal to death.~~ **expose an animal to heat or cold beyond an animal's tolerance based on the animal's:**

- (i) age;**
- (ii) health;**
- (iii) medical conditions; or**
- (iv) physical characteristics;**

which results in pain, suffering, or death; or

(E) to knowingly, intentionally, or recklessly starve, dehydrate, or suffocate an animal."

Delete pages 8 through 9.

Page 10, delete lines 1 through 13.

Page 14, delete lines 40 through 42.

Delete page 15.

Renumber all SECTIONS consecutively.

and when so amended that said bill do pass.

(Reference is to HB 1165 as printed January 22, 2026.)

FREEMAN, Chairperson

Committee Vote: Yeas 9, Nays 0.

SENATE MOTION

Mr. President: I move that Engrossed House Bill 1165 be amended to read as follows:

Page 13, delete lines 6 through 9, begin a new paragraph and insert:

~~"(c)~~ **(d) It is a defense to a prosecution under this section:**

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- (1) that the accused person:
 - (1) (A) engaged in a reasonable act of training, handling, or discipline; and
 - (2) (B) acted as an employee or agent of a law enforcement agency; or
- (2) that:
 - (A) the actions of the accused person were objectively reasonable and taken in good faith to protect the person or another individual from imminent injury by the law enforcement animal; and
 - (B) neither the accused person nor the other individual substantially contributed to the circumstances leading to the deployment of the law enforcement animal."

(Reference is to EHB 1165 as printed February 13, 2026.)

TAYLOR G

